Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Planning a gallery or exhibition inquiry

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How do we design a structured visual inquiry plan to analyse artworks in an exhibition space?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why is a quick floorplan and lighting sketch in Zone 1 just as important as sketching the artwork itself?

Correct: Because an exhibition is a 3D spatial experience — scale, plinth height, and spotlight angles change how the artwork reads — Exactly! Recording the curatorial framing alongside the artwork gives you complete critical evidence.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Which of these is a sharp 'critical inquiry question' for an exhibition study? -> How does the artist combine rough industrial texture with high-contrast directional lighting to create a sense of weight? (Yes! It connects material process, curatorial lighting, and audience impact.)

Q2: Why should your field-sketching kit for an exhibition study be compact and dry (e.g. 2B/4B graphite, fineliner, and two toned markers)? -> Compact dry media let you capture rapid tonal values, crisp contours, and lighting notes cleanly on a clipboard (Correct. Fast, portable dry media are ideal for live

gallery observation.)

Q3: How will you use the Inquiry sheet you prepare today during Weeks 6 and 7? -> In Week 6 we fill the zones with live observational sketches and notes; in Week 7 we use that evidence to write our critical review (Spot on. Today's framework is the backbone of your Week 6 study and Week 7 review.)

Exit check answer

Question: Why do we prepare structured recording zones and critical questions BEFORE studying an exhibition?

Correct: So our observation is focused on capturing spatial layout, tonal structure, and material evidence systematically — Correct. Preparation turns observation into rigorous visual research.